Travel Through the Magical World of Harry Potter

Unfortunately for us muggles with that wanderlust itch, the amazing world of Harry Potter does not exist for us to travel to. However, luckily for us many of the beautiful places depicted in the books and movies are based off of real locations. Some dedicated fans have even taken it a step further, and have created bars, restaurants, and theme parks to try and capture the wizarding experience. So for those of you still waiting on your acceptance letter from Hogwarts, here are the places- both real and imagined- that helped to create the world of the Harry Potter series.

Filming Locations:

- Hogwarts:
    - Alnwick Castle- Northumberland, UK(filming location for the exterior of Hogwarts in the Sorcerer's Stone and most recognized for the broomstick training scene)
    - Black Park- Buckinghamshire (filming location for Forbidden Forest)
    - Durham Cathedral (filming location for Hogwarts)
    - Glencoe, Scotland (filming for Hogwart's grounds in Prisoner of Azkaban and Hagrid's Hut)
    - Goathland Station- North Yorkshire, England
    - Harrow School (filming location for the charms class where Hermione schools Ron in how to properly "Leviosa" in the Sorcerer's Stone)
    - Jacobite Steam Train in Scotland- (The real life Hogwart's Express)
    - Lacock Abbey- Wiltshire England (filming location for Hogwarts in Chamber of Secrets)
    - Loch Schiel- Scotland, UK (filming for Harry's flight on Buckbeak over the Great Lake in Prisoner of Azkaban)
    - Loch Morar- Scotland- Uk (filming location for the Great Lake)
    - Steall Falls- Scottish Highlands, UK (filming location for Hogwarts' grounds and memorable for Harry's battle with a dragon in the Triwizard Tournament in Goblet of Fire)

- The Muggle World:
    - 12 Picket Post Close, Bracknell, Berkshire. (filming for 4 Privet Drive, Little Whinging, Surrey)
    - Hampstead Garden Suburb in Heathgate, London (filming location for the Grangers' home where Hermione "obliviates" her parents in Deathly Hallows Part 1)
    - Millenium Bridge- London, UK (where the Death Eaters attack muggles in Deathly Hallows Part 1)
    - Piccadilly Circus- London, Uk (where Hermione apparates Ron and Harry to escape the Death Eaters' attack on Bill and Fleur's wedding in Deathly Hallows Part 1)
    - Reptile House at the London Zoo (memorable for when Harry accidentally sets a python on Dudley in the Sorcerer's Stone)
    - Malham Cove- North Yorkshire, England (Harry and Hermione set up a tent on the limestone cliffs while hunting for Horcruxes in Deathly Hallows Part 1)
    - St Pancras Renaissance Hotel- London, Uk (filming location for entrance to King's cross station)

- The Wizarding World:
    - Australia House- London, UK (filming location for lobby of Gringott's Bank)
    - Claremont Square- London, UK (filming location for Grimmauld Place)
    - King's Cross Station- London, UK (home of Platform 9 ¾)
    - Leadenhall Market (filming for Diagon Alley- it's a covered Victorian market, one of the oldest markets in London, was the location for several exterior shots of Diagon Alley. Bull's Head Passage you may recognize the blue door of an optics shop (an empty storefront at the time of shooting) as the entrance to the Leaky Cauldron.
    - Seven Sisters Country Park (filming location of where the Weasleys and Harry meet the Diggorys to take a portkey to the Quidditch World Cup)

Inspiration:

These are the real-world places that inspired J.K. Rowling while she was writing the series. The influence of their more extraordinary characteristics can be seen in the fictional places she created for the world of Harry Potter.

- Elephant House in Scotland, UK (a cafe where JK Rowling wrote the first Harry Potter book)
- Livraria Lello Bookstore in Portugal (JK Rowling worked here for a time. It is known as one of the most beautiful bookstores in the world, and its ornate staircases inspired the moving staircases in Hogwarts)
- Oxford University (inspiration for Great Hall in Hogwarts)
    - Duke Humfrey's Library in the Bodleian Library (It is the oldest reading room in Oxford and served as the inspiration for the restricted section in Hogwarts' Library because the most valuable books were chained to the shelves for security until modern times)

Themed:

The world of Harry Potter has become so beloved that there are many places around the world that have dedicated themselves to try and bring its magic to life.

- Czocha Castle- Poland (A role play vacation experience where you can live your best wizarding life by spending a few days taking magic classes and being sorted into “houses”)
- Georgian House -London, UK (A hotel with several rooms decorated to capture Harry Potter’s aesthetic)
- Harry Potter Studio Tour in England
- Lockhart- Toronto, Canada (a harry potter inspired bar)
- Universal Studios Parks